

IAN HENRY

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PROFILE | Staff software engineer specializing in performance, reliability, and zero-to-one product launches. Seeking a role at the intersection of technology and social impact.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Co-founded multiple greenfield initiatives at Meta, driving technical and organizational alignment from ideation to scale, reaching millions of users
- Diverse and deep experience across many languages & frameworks: Javascript, React, Python, C/C++, PHP/Hack, C#, Obj-C
- Skilled at parachuting into new tech stacks and large legacy codebases, delivering impact quickly
- Cultivates cohesive team culture rooted in technical craftsmanship, dedicating time to onboard, mentor and teach engineers across all seniority levels
- Energized by data-driven performance and reliability optimization work

EXPERIENCE

META | STAFF SOFTWARE ENGINEER | AUGUST 2018 - APRIL 2025

Instagram for Oculus (May 2024 - April 2025)

- Early member of team building brand new Instagram app for Oculus VR headsets
- Owned most ambiguous and complex features, requiring full-stack expertise across front-end (Javascript, React Native, GraphQL) and back-end GraphQL and REST APIs in Python
- Onboarded performance and reliability metrics, dashboards, and alerting
- Tech lead for the core app surfaces team post-launch: managed roadmap, scoped feature work, collaborated with PM and design team, onboarded and mentored junior engineers

Messenger for iOS & Android (February 2024 - May 2024)

- Tech lead for short-term high-priority cross-org initiative tasked with improving media quality for the Messenger mobile apps
- Reverse engineered huge Java, C++ and PHP codebases for Messenger mobile and authored doc summarizing problem domain, technical/architectural overview, workstreams
- Built system to quantify quality of media sent and received via MS-SSIM, and built out roadmap of features to improve quality

Messenger for Desktop, Foundations (January 2022 - February 2024)

- Engineer focused on product performance and reliability
- Data, metrics and observability champion: ensured performance and reliability of all features could be quantified and visualized on dashboards
- Solved hardest technical problems requiring deep expertise in Javascript and C/C++ codebases
- Crash reliability expert: consistently solved obscure crashes and improved reliability of crash reporting infrastructure in Javascript and C++
- Performance expert: significantly improved speed of core app functionality (app launch, message sending, chat thread loading), leveraging framework and OS tooling
- Release process owner: ensured new product releases maintained a high quality bar
- Onboarded, mentored and taught junior and senior engineers across the org

Messenger for Desktop V2, Product (July 2020 - January 2022)

- Product engineer, fully rebuilding Messenger Desktop using React Native (for improved performance and reliability)
- Go-to engineer for the hardest technical problems across the full tech stack, C/C++ and Javascript
 - Wrote a codegen engine in Javascript that generates 30k+ lines of C++
 - Data and telemetry infrastructure in Javascript, C++, PHP/Hack
 - Build/release/continuous integration tooling/automation in PHP/Hack, Javascript
 - Data and metrics expert, partnering with data science to ensure that the performance and reliability of all features can be quantified and visualized on dashboards
- Tech lead for launch, managed team of 10+ engineers across multiple teams tasked with ensuring engagement metric match v1: tracked work, ran daily meetings, communicated progress

Messenger for Desktop, Product (August 2018 - July 2020)

- Built multiple prototype products on desktop using Javascript/React and PHP
- Shipped the first version of Messenger for Desktop, built using electron and React/Javascript
- Expertise in authentication (single sign on), Windows push notifications
- Tech lead for launch, for build/release infrastructure, and release process
- Reliability expert, reduced crash rate post-launch by 3x

MICROSOFT | SOFTWARE ENGINEER II | AUGUST 2012 - AUGUST 2018

Web Services (August 2017 - August 2018)

- Built, maintained, and monitored scalable web services for the Microsoft Universal Store using C# and ASP.NET WebAPI

App Developer (July 2015 - August 2017)

- Mobile and desktop developer across a variety of first-party apps:
 - Podcast App: tech lead for brand new app: wrote the design doc, built core parts of the app using XAML and C#, mentored other engineers
 - Groove Music App: implemented features using C#, C++/CX and XAML.
 - Office for iOS/Mac: built new features using Objective-C

Operating Systems (August 2014 - June 2015)

- Windows Phone mobile engineer, working in C++ and C# across Windows Phone OS codebase

Engineering Systems (August 2012 - April 2014)

- Front-end web developer, building applications to manage build and test runs for the Windows Phone OS codebase using ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET WebAPI, Javascript, jQuery and CSS

INTERNSHIPS | MAY 2010 - AUGUST 2011 | SOFTWARE ENGINEER INTERN

Recon Instruments (May 2011 - August 2011) - mobile engineer on an embedded Android product: Java and Android SDK

Research In Motion / Blackberry (January 2011 - April 2011) - web application developer: Java, PHP, Javascript, HTML and CSS

Vision Critical (May 2010 - August 2010) - web application developer: SQL, PHP, VB.NET, C#

EDUCATION | Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada | 2008-2012